

Boston Sunday Globe

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Big cuts to hit research funding

Millions at risk for Boston area

By Jonathan Wosen,
Megan Molteni,
Jason Mast, and
Usha Lee McFarling
STAT

The National Institutes of Health, the nation's premier funder of biomedical research, plans to immediately slash support for "indirect costs" paid to universities, medical centers, and other research grant recipients, funding the nation's science enterprise relies on for basic operating costs.

► **Judge halts DOGE's Treasury payment access.** A11.

In an announcement issued Friday night by the NIH Office of the Director, the agency noted it has historically supported indirect costs — administrative, facility, and other expenses not directly linked to the goals of a scientific project — with

NIH, Page A12

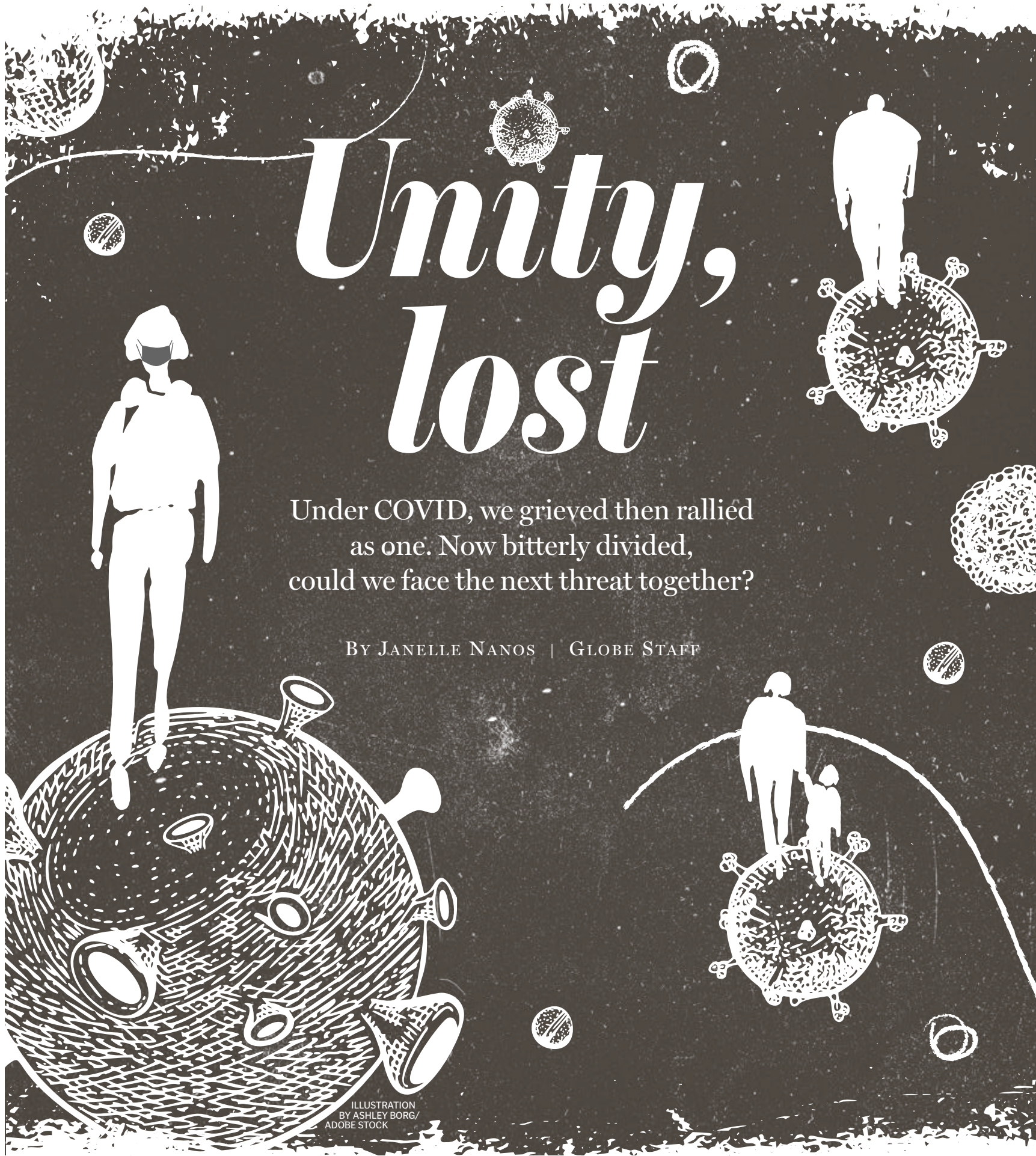
A loud silence on RFK Jr.'s candidacy

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — After Senator Thom Tillis cast his vote to advance the nomination of Robert F. Kennedy Jr. to be health secretary, the North Carolina Republican posed a question. If Kennedy was so bad, where was the opposition from large interest groups?

"I believe that silence is consent," Tillis said of the apparent lack of outreach from stakeholders in agriculture, gun rights, and abortion opposition. "And the fact they haven't [spoken out] suggests to me that folks that I'm instructed by are OK with this nomination."

KENNEDY, Page A12



Huddled in our homes, we rallied. We sewed masks, delivered groceries to neighbors in need, and spun up mutual aid groups. We celebrated first responders and front-line workers, and sacrificed time with loved ones even as we spent long days juggling work and children.

All the while, a grim toll mounted, with the coronavirus at one point claiming over 4,000 American lives a day. As we mourned, we often grieved how they died, isolated and alone.

Yes, there were those who immediately dug in their heels at the thought of shutting down their lives and dismissed the significance of the virus or wearing masks. And yes, within weeks, bizarre theories began to emerge, even from the White House.

But mostly, we watched as our federal and state governments made enormous investments in those in need, bailing out whole industries and sending \$1,200 checks to nearly everyone, no questions asked. We halted evictions, extended unemployment benefits, and,

for a time, halved child poverty. Meanwhile our scientists concocted a vaccine at a breakneck pace, and some of us wept with joy as the first shot went in our arms.

It was a revelatory moment for our nation, the kind that happens perhaps once in a generation. Like after 9/11, John F. Kennedy's assassination, or World War II. Despite being physically apart, we united against a common enemy, and in the first few months after

COVID, Page A14

For artist of Black life, long overdue recognition

In 1987, John Wilson worked on the final clay of "Eternal Presence," which keeps vigil over the National Center of Afro-American Artists in Roxbury.



JOHN WILSON ARCHIVE/MFA

MFA features John Wilson's works of dignity, humanity

By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF

On a chilly day in January 1986, Boston artist John Wilson wrapped a bronze sculpture he'd recently completed in an old sleeping bag, stuffed it into the back of the family Mazda, and drove south for Washington, D.C.

Wilson was headed for a building he'd never visited before — the US Capitol, where his bust of Martin Luther King Jr. would be installed in the grand Rotunda as the building's first artwork to honor a Black man.

It was an undeniable achievement on a

grand stage; yet for Wilson, who sought to portray Black life with nuance and dignity, it was also a rarity in his decades-long struggle to achieve national recognition.

"Friends would ask about my dad," recalled his daughter Erica Wilson, "and I would say: 'Well, he has paintings in most of the major museums, some internationally, but nobody knows him.'"

That may be about to change: On Saturday, the MFA unveiled "Witnessing Humanity: The Art of John Wilson," the largest-ever retrospec-

WILSON, Page A15

Stage-to-screen musicals have historically yielded more misses than hits. But has Hollywood figured it out? **SundayArts, N1.**

Sleepovers are a rite of passage, yet they can also be a battleground. **Globe Magazine.**

Catch my drift

Sunday: Snowy.
High: 33-38. Low: 20-25.
Monday: Sunny, breezy.
High: 31-36. Low: 14-19.

Complete report, **A22.**
Deaths, **A16-21.**

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